Riccardo Carlesso

Staff Developer Advocate (L6) · Agentic AI & SRE Specialist · Cloud Architect · University Lecturer

Zurich, Switzerland · Italian Citizen · **Google Zurich**
riccardo.carlesso@gmail.com
ricc.rocks · LinkedIn · GitHub · Medium
g.dev/ricc · sessionize.com/riccardo-carlesso

Executive Profile: Staff Developer Advocate, Principal Cloud Architect, and AI Agentic Systems Engineer with 20+ years in distributed systems, SRE, and software engineering. Global co-owner of Google's flagship **"The Art of SLOs"** program (official video); international speaker at **Google Cloud Next (Las Vegas)**, **George UX Conf (Vienna)**, **Codemotion (Milan)**, and **SRE Day (Amsterdam Keynote)**. Author of open-source agentic AI harnesses and SDKs (Model Context Protocol, Gemini API, Policy Engine DSL). University Lecturer at **Hochschule Luzern (HSLU)** teaching two postgraduate CAS cloud computing courses. 2x full Ironman triathlete & classical pianist.

PROFESSIONAL & ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

GOOGLE CLOUD · Zurich, Switzerland & Dublin, Ireland — **May 2012 – Present (14+ years)**

Staff Developer Advocate (L6) – Agentic AI, Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) & DevX — *2021 – Present · Zurich, Switzerland*

- **Agentic AI & Autonomous SRE Systems:** Pioneered autonomous skill-based SRE agents integrating Gemini multimodal models with Model Context Protocol (MCP) and Agent Development Kit (ADK) for live Kubernetes diagnostics, metric regression analysis, and automated incident postmortems. Created open-source AI agent harnesses (`antigravity-ruby-sdk` with Policy Engine DSL, `sre-extension`).
- **"The Art of SLOs" Global Leadership:** Global co-owner and lead of Google's primary SRE enablement curriculum. Authored the official course (YouTube · sre.google); founded the international trainer network; delivered workshops across Japan, UK, Germany, Spain, and Italy.
- **Product Influence & DevX:** Partnered with Cloud Deploy and Vertex AI engineering teams; authored official multi-environment canary deployment blueprints (Video · GitHub) and conducted systematic friction logs.

Strategic Customer Engineer (SCE) / TAM Lead – Professional Services (PSO) ("Forward Deployed Engineers ante-litteram") — *2015 – 2021 · Zurich, Switzerland*

- **Enterprise Client Leadership:** Lead architect for top EMEA accounts: **Lufthansa** (HPC Operations Research infrastructure), **Deutsche Bank** (executive cloud architecture), **SAP** (governed multi-stream delivery & hybrid cloud networking), **Iponweb** (zero-downtime ad-tech migration AWS to GCE), **Wix** (global Cloud DNS resilience).
- **DACH Team Lead (2018–2019) & Tooling:** Scoped enterprise engagements and mentored SCEs across DACH. Conceived and built automated telemetry and data pipelines serving 1,000+ engineers globally; established Centers of Excellence across EMEA and APAC.

Enterprise Technical Solutions Engineer (TSE) – Cloud Support — *2012 – 2015 · Dublin & Zurich*

- Supported initial launch of Google Compute Engine (GCE), GAE, and Cloud Storage. Built HA cloud architectures and internal automation microservices; established quaternary pager rotations for Support and TAM teams.

HOCHSCHULE LUZERN (HSLU) – LUCERNE UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES AND ARTS — **May 2023 – Present · Rotkreuz / Lucerne, Switzerland**

- **University Lecturer (2 Postgraduate CAS Courses):** External lecturer at HSLU Informatik for CAS Cloud and Platform Manager (CAS CPM) (across 7 cohorts: CAS CPM 7–13) & CAS Cloud Architecture (new program). Teaches **Google Cloud Platform (GCP)** foundations, enterprise landing zones, IAM/networking, Cloud Run/GKE, Gemini AI, and SRE practices.

PRIOR ENGINEERING & SYSTEMS LEADERSHIP — **2002 – 2012 (10 years)**

- **Dell Inc. (2011–2012 | Cloud Senior Developer · Dublin):** Core contributor to open-source *Crowbar* bare-metal cloud installer; automated hypervisors (KVM, Xen, Ganeti, ESXi) and early OpenStack (Nova, Swift); puppetized Linux dev fleet.
- **HEAnet (2009–2011 | Network Systems Developer · Dublin):** Full-stack Ruby on Rails, Python, Perl, Bash; Request Tracker (RT) internals; HA Debian/Ubuntu fleet; 24/7 NOC on-call engineer.
- **Laboratori Guglielmo Marconi (2003–2008 | Senior Network Engineer · Bologna):** Enterprise networks for 5,000+ users (PA/Healthcare); security expert & PM on EU railway research consortia (*Euromain*, *Integrail*); 1-year NOC shift rota.
- **Università di Bologna (2002–2003 | Academic Researcher):** Taught *Vision Mathematics* with Prof. Massimo Ferri; published ARCES computer vision paper on shadow removal in video surveillance.

KEYNOTE & INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE SPEAKING (WITH VIDEOS & SLIDES)

Google Cloud Next Las Vegas (2024): *"Goodbye, Deployment Headaches: Cloud Deploy and Vertex AI Unite"* (DEV302 · YouTube Video · PDF Slides).
George UX Conf Vienna (2023): *"Reimagining Customer Services with GenAI and Multi-Modal Interaction"* (~1,800 attendees · YouTube Video).
DevSecOps Day Bologna (2024 Keynote): *"Where SRE Can Go Wrong / Dove l'SRE può andare storto"* (YouTube Video · Speaker Page).
SRE Day Amsterdam (2024 Keynote): *"SRE Gone Wrong: Top 7 Errors (and How to Avoid Them)"* (Keynote Page · Related GDG Video).
RubyDay Verona (2024): *"News Crawler via LangChain.RB and Gemini APIs"* (YouTube Video) · **Rubycon Italy (2026):** Co-organizer & MC (Welcome Video).
Codemotion Milan (2026): *"Stop Grepping, Start Reasoning: Skill-Based Agentic SRE 🚀"* (Article & Demo) · **CloudConf Turin (2025, 2024)** · **Euruko (Sarajevo 2024, Portugal 2025)**.

AI, TECHNICAL SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Generative & Agentic AI: Agentic Harnesses, Multi-Agent Orchestration, Model Context Protocol (MCP), Google ADK, Gemini API (Multimodal, Vision, Audio/TTS, Veo, Imagen 3, Lyria 3), RAG, LangChain / `langchain.rb`, Policy Guardrails.

Core SRE & Cloud: SRE, SLOs/Error Budgets, GCP (GCE, Cloud Run, GKE, Vertex AI, Cloud Deploy, BigQuery), K8s, Docker, Pulumi, Terraform.

Languages: Ruby (advanced / gem author), **Bash** (expert), Python, Go, SQL (BigQuery/Dremel), C/C++.

Certifications: GCP Professional DevOps Engineer · GCP Cloud Architect · GCP Data Engineer · Cisco CCNA.

EDUCATION, LANGUAGES & PERSONAL

University Education: Laurea Quinquennale Ingegneria Informatica (5-Yr BS+MS, 99/100, AI/Computer Vision thesis, Univ. Bologna) · Post-Grad Master in Information Security (1,500h) · State Engineering License (2002).

Academic Honors: Scuola Normale Superiore di Pisa (Selected for Cortona Orientation, top 150 students in Italy, 1994) · Maturità 60/60.

Languages: Italian (Native C2) · English (Fluent C1/C2) · Portuguese (B2) · French (B1) · German (A2/B1).

Endurance & Art: 2x Full Ironman finisher (3.8k swim, 180k bike, 42.2k run) · Classical pianist (YouTube) · Built *goliardia.it* (2002).